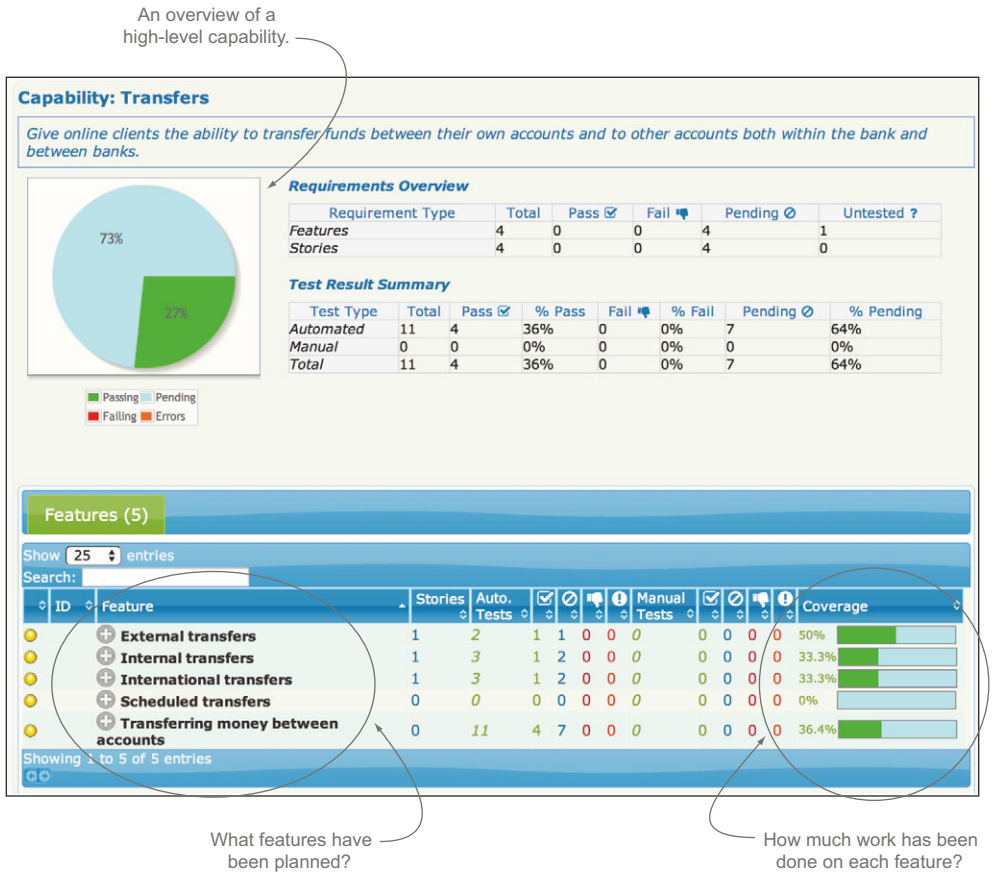


Figure 1.12 Well-organized living documentation can give an overview of the state of a project, as well as describe features in detail.

USE LIVING DOCUMENTATION TO SUPPORT ONGOING MAINTENANCE WORK

The benefits of living documentation and executable specifications don't stop at the end of the project. A project developed using these practices is also significantly easier and less expensive to maintain.

According to Robert L. Glass (quoting other sources), maintenance represents between 40% and 80% of software costs. Although many teams find that the number of defects drops dramatically when they adopt techniques like BDD, defects can still happen. Ongoing enhancements are also a natural part of any software application.[19]

In many organizations, when a project goes into production, it's handed over to a different team for maintenance work. The developers involved in this maintenance work have often not been involved in the project's development and need to learn the

[19] Robert L. Glass, *Facts and Fallacies of Software Engineering* (Addison-Wesley Professional, 2002).